

Relay — Beta Test Guide

How to use Relay as a real person would, what to try deliberately, and what to tell us afterwards. Written 2026-08-19 for the first beta cohort.

Relay is live software holding real things for real people. It has been built and tested end to end by the person who wrote it — which is the problem this round is meant to fix. **Nobody outside the project has ever used it.** That is the single gap between where Relay is now and a product anyone can honestly say works.

You are one of about five people who will change that. This guide walks you through setting it up, tells you exactly which things to try, and — most usefully — tells you what we need to hear back. **Confusion is the finding.** If a screen does not make sense, that is not you failing the test; that is the test working.

What we are actually measuring. Two things, and neither is "did it crash". **(1) Does the setup make sense to somebody who did not build it?** Every instruction here was written by the author, so every place you hesitate is a place the product is unclear. **(2) Do the people who get named actually accept?** That number — how many invited people claim their standby account, and how long it takes them — is the one measurement the whole design rests on, and it is currently zero because nobody has been asked.

Who is doing what

ROLE	WHO	WHAT YOU DO
Owner	Steve	Sets everything up, names people, fires the test emergencies, stands them down.
Recipient	Doug, and any tester who wants the fullest experience	Someone who would <i>receive</i> access. Claims a standby account, waits, and on the test day opens what was set aside.
Verifier	2–3 other testers	Someone who <i>confirms it is real</i> . Answers one question and never sees anything inside the vault.

One person can hold both roles, and the product supports that deliberately — but for a first round it is cleaner if each tester holds one, so we learn what each experience is like on its own.

● **This is production, not a sandbox.** There is one Relay and you are using it. Real emails are sent, real accounts are created, and anything you type into the vault is really encrypted and really stored. It is also all deletable — there is a working "close my account" that removes everything — but nothing you do here is pretend. **See §0.3 for what to put in the vault.**

What is in this guide

- Part 0** Before you start — ground rules, what to expect, what not to report
- Part 1** Owner setup (Steve) — the seven steps, in order, and the one that breaks everything if skipped
- Part 2** Standby setup (everyone else) — claiming your account, in about two minutes

- Part 3** The tests — eight scenarios, who runs each, what should happen
 - Part 4** What to tell us — the questions that matter, and how to send them
 - Part 5** Known limits — things that are deliberate, so you do not report them as faults
-

Part 0 — Before you start

GROUND RULES · FIFTEEN MINUTES OF READING THAT SAVES AN AFTERNOON

0.1 — Everything happens at relaystandby.com

There is no app to install. Everything is a web page, and it works on a phone. If you are a recipient or verifier, **use your phone for at least part of the test** — the emergency case is a phone case, and the screens are built for it, so that is where problems will show up.

Relay never sends a link that signs you in. Ever. You get a short code and you type it into a page you navigated to yourself. If you ever receive a message with a "click here to access" link claiming to be Relay, it is not from us — and telling us you got one *is* a useful finding.

0.2 — Email will probably land in your junk folder

This is a known, measured problem and one of the things we would like this round to help settle. Relay's mail authenticates perfectly and still gets filed as junk by Microsoft — Outlook.com, Hotmail, Live and MSN addresses are the worst affected. Gmail is generally fine.

- **Check your junk/spam folder before saying "nothing arrived".**
- **Do tell us where it landed** — inbox or junk, and which mail provider you use. That is real data we cannot get any other way.
- If it landed in junk, **please do not mark it "not junk" yet** — tell us first. We are trying to measure the filter's default behaviour, and training it changes what we can observe.

0.3 — What to actually put in the vault

Only Steve does this part, but everyone should know the answer, because it shapes what the test proves.

USE	WHY
One real account you genuinely control and would not miss — a streaming service, a loyalty card, a spare email account	The reveal test is only meaningful if what comes out the other end actually works. Ideally one with two-factor turned on, so the code-generation half gets exercised too.
Two or three realistic but invented entries — "Main bank", "House insurance", a note with instructions	They render the same screens as real ones and make the vault look like a real vault, which is what we are testing the feel of.

Do not put in anything you would be hurt by losing control of. Not your primary email, not your actual bank, not anything financial that matters. Relay's encryption is real — plaintext never leaves the browser and the server

genuinely cannot read it — but this is a beta with five users and one operator, and the sensible posture for a beta is that it has not earned your most important secrets yet. That will change; today it has not.

0.4 — How long things take

Some steps are instant and some genuinely are not, by design. Knowing which is which stops you waiting for something that already happened, or reporting a bug that is a deliberate delay.

STEP	HOW LONG	NOTES
Signing up, claiming, adding items	Instant	
Owner fires an emergency → verifiers are asked	Instant	Email send is best-effort; see §0.2
Verifier confirms → access opens	Instant	For emergency, travel, caregiver and business there is no waiting period. Quorum is met, access opens.
Owner checks in → access closes	Instant	
Recipient asks → the owner gets first refusal	2 hours (emergency) 4 h travel/business · 6 h caregiver	Deliberate. The owner is asked before anyone else is bothered. Only when the window runs out are verifiers contacted — see T4.
Owner stops checking in → the plan arms itself	At least a full day	The shortest check-in interval you can set is one day, and the checker runs hourly. This is the slow test; see T7.

Part 1 — Owner setup

STEVE · ABOUT FORTY MINUTES, ONCE

Seven steps. Do them in order — several depend on the one before. **Step 6 is the one that silently breaks the whole test if you skip it**, so it has its own warning.

1.1 — Sign up, and keep the recovery codes

Go to `relaystandby.com` and create an account. You will set up an authenticator app (the six-digit code kind) — that is the only way back in, so it is not optional.

Relay

Create your vault

Two steps. An authenticator app is required — there is no password.

Email address

Your name (optional)

This is how you appear to the people you trust — they will see "your email address" when we contact them.

Continue

Already have an account? [Sign in](#)

Sign-up. The authenticator step comes immediately after; do not close the tab until it is finished.

Write the recovery codes down on paper. They are shown once. If you lose your phone and have no recovery codes, there is no support desk that can let you back in — that is a property of the design, not an oversight. Testing the recovery path is **T8**, and it needs those codes.

1.2 — Put a few things in the vault

Add three or four items per \$0.3. Each item can hold a username, a password, a two-factor seed and recovery codes as separate labelled fields — use at least one item with all four, because that is the item that proves the most on the day.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

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Help

Sign out

Nothing is in your vault yet, so there is nothing anyone could reach.

Missing: nobody who can confirm an emergency is real.

Your plan cannot run yet

Send a recipient their code. Verifiers could agree, but nobody is set up to receive anything. [Go to your circle](#)

Still to set up

Your vault is empty — there is nothing to give anyone access to. [Go](#)

Nobody is named to receive access. Add the person who would step in. [Go](#)

Add item

The secret is encrypted in your browser before it is sent.

Title

e.g. Gmail

Type

login

Criticality

medium

Service name (optional)

Google

Category (optional)

—

URL (optional)

https://...

Username (optional)

The email or name you sign in with

Secret value

Password, note, or instructions – encrypted before upload

Two-factor code (optional)

otpauth://totp/... or the setup key

From your authenticator app's "can't scan the code?" text. Whoever you name will get the six digits, not this.

Recovery codes (optional)

One per line – the backup codes the service gave you

Note for your recipient (optional)

e.g. This is the account everything else resets through. Recovery codes are in the desk drawer.

Not encrypted — unlike the secret above, so never put a password or a code here. Say what the account is for, or how to get in if the password no longer works.

Save item

Cancel

Adding an item. The fields are separate on purpose — the person who receives this later gets labelled fields, not a wall of text.

1.3 — Name the people

On the People screen, add each tester. Two different jobs, and confusing them is how a plan ends up doing nothing:

- **Recipients** receive access to items you assign them, and only after a release opens.

- **Verifiers** answer one question — is this genuine? — and never receive access to anything.

For this round: Doug as a recipient, and two or three others as verifiers.

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If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 4 of the things that matter.

People

Who would step in, who would be asked whether an emergency is real, and what each of them could reach.

Naming someone is the first half. Once they accept, call them and check the phrase matches — until you do, their answer would not count towards opening anything.

Everyone is named — but 1 of them has not been verified yet.

Until you check it is really them, their answer would not count towards opening anything. It is a two-minute call each.

Suggested starting point

Built from what the importance engine already knows. Accept what fits.

Pat Morgan gets act access to 2 items on an emergency trigger

Root credentials are the reset path for everything else. Without them, nothing else can be recovered.

Accept

Pat Morgan gets view access to 2 items on an emergency trigger

Critical money and health accounts are what a caregiver reaches for first.

Accept

Who holds what

PERSON	ROLE	ITEMS REACHABLE
Pat Morgan	caregiver	1 / 25
Jordan Rivera	partner	4 / 25

Who would step in

The people who would receive access. Nothing opens for them until a trigger fires and the people you named confirm it is real — and a person you have not verified cannot receive anything.

Pat Morgan

caregiver

Accepted — not yet verified, so their answer would not count

pat@example.com

If Pat Morgan loses the device they signed in on, they cannot get back in. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey.

Check it is really them

Rename

Remove

Emergency code

Jordan Rivera

partner

Verified — their answer counts

jordan@example.com

If Jordan Rivera loses the device they signed in on, they cannot get back in. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey.

Verified — undo

Rename

Remove

Emergency code

Name

Email

recipient

Relationship (optional)

Phone (optional)

Add this person

Who confirms it is real

They are asked whether an emergency is real. Their answer only counts once you have checked it is really them. They never see what is inside your vault — only how much, and only when they are asked.

Sam Rivera

Verified — their answer counts

sam@example.com

No passkey — an emergency code is their only way back in. Worth checking Sam Rivera still knows where it is.

Verified — undo

Rename

Remove

Emergency code

Dr. Alex Chen

Verified — their answer counts

achen@example.com

No passkey — an emergency code is their only way back in. Worth checking Dr. Alex Chen still knows where it is.

Verified — undo

Rename

Remove

Emergency code

Name

Email

Phone (optional)

Add a verifier

The People screen. Each person's line says what is still *missing*, not merely what state they are in — that is the list to work down.

1.4 — Issue each person a claim code

Open a person's panel and issue their invitation. You will get a short code.

The code is readable exactly once. Only a hash is kept. If you close the panel before copying it, the invitation has to be cancelled and reissued. Copy it somewhere before you close anything.

There is a script that does the whole cohort in one go and captures every code — `npm run invite:cohort`, dry-run by default. It also prints a ready-to-send message per person. Using it is the recommended path for a cohort of five.

1.5 — Deliver the codes yourself

Text them, read them out on a call, hand them over. **Do not email the code** for the people you are testing the owner-delivered arm with — half the point of the round is comparing "Steve told me" against "Relay emailed me", and doing both to one person destroys that comparison.

1.6 — ● Make the four-word call. Do not skip this.

After each person claims, before any test

Once someone accepts, Relay derives four words from their account. You call them — an actual phone call — and check the four words on your screen match the four words on theirs. Then you mark them verified.

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If something happened tomorrow, Jordan Rivera could reach the one thing that matters.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Your plan cannot run yet

Confirm a recipient who has already claimed. Verifiers could agree, but nobody is set up to receive anything. [Go to your circle](#)

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

People

Who would step in, who would be asked whether an emergency is real, and what each of them could reach.

Naming someone is the first half.

Once they accept, call them and check the phrase matches — until you do, their answer would not count towards opening anything.

Everyone is named — but 1 of them has not been verified yet.

Until you check it is really them, their answer would not count towards opening anything. It is a two-minute call each.

Suggested starting point

Built from what the importance engine already knows. Accept what fits.

Jordan Rivera gets act access to 1 item on an emergency trigger

Root credentials are the reset path for everything else. Without them, nothing else can be recovered.

Accept

Who holds what

PERSON	ROLE	ITEMS REACHABLE
Jordan Rivera	partner	1 / 1

Who would step in

The people who would receive access. Nothing opens for them until a trigger fires and the people you named confirm it is real — and a person you have not verified cannot receive anything.

Jordan Rivera

partner

Accepted — not yet verified, so their answer would not count

ra-jordan@relay.invalid

If Jordan Rivera loses the device they signed in on, they cannot get back in. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey.

Call Jordan Rivera and read this out

granite forest mitten granite

They see the same four words on their own screen. Speaking to them is the point — it is the one channel nobody else can reach, and it is what tells you the person who accepted is the person you meant.

The words matched

They did not match

Not now

Emergency code

Remove

Name

Email

recipient

Relationship (optional)

Phone (optional)

Add this person

Who confirms it is real

They are asked whether an emergency is real. Their answer only counts once you have checked it is really them. They never see what is inside your vault — only how much, and only when they are asked.

Dr. Alex Chen

Verified — their answer counts

ra-chen@relay.invalid

If Dr. Alex Chen loses the device they signed in on, they cannot get back in. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey.

Verified — undo

Emergency code

Remove

Name

Email

Phone (optional)

Add a verifier

Your side of the call.

RELAY

You are on standby

Nothing is open. There is nothing you need to do today.

Margaret Chen

If an emergency is confirmed by the people they trust, what they set aside for you opens. Until then it stays sealed, and it closes again when they check back in.

Margaret Chen will call you and read out four words. These are yours – they should be the same.

granite forest mitten granite

If they do not match, say so and stop – it means somebody else opened the invitation meant for you. Nothing is lost; they can start again on a channel you both trust.

Set aside for you: 1 item – 1 communication. You cannot see what they are, and neither can we.

Nothing open.

Ask Margaret Chen to open it

[Step down from this](#)

Make sure you can get back in

Set up your face, fingerprint or device PIN for this account. Then a new phone will not lock you out, and there is no code to keep somewhere – nothing we could send you that a stranger could imitate. You can do this later.

Set this up

Who would step in for you?

You are covering someone else. The same thing can be set up for your own family, and the first ten items are free.

Start your own plan

Their side. The words must match. If they do not, something is wrong and the person should not be marked verified.

If you skip this, the test will fail in a way that looks like a bug and is not. An unverified verifier can press Confirm, and the screen will accept it — but their answer **does not count toward the quorum**, so the release stays stuck and access never opens. Nothing dramatic happens; it just quietly does not work. This is deliberate: it is what stops somebody who intercepted an invitation from being able to vouch for an emergency. **Every verifier must be verified by phone before T1 through T5 will do anything.**

1.7 — Decide who can reach what, and set the trigger

On the Rules screen, connect people to items: which recipient gets which things, under which condition. Then on the Triggers screen, set how many verifiers have to agree.

For this round, set the emergency trigger to require 1 confirmation. It is the default, and it keeps the first test simple — one verifier answers and access opens. Raise it to 2 later for T5 if you want to see the quorum arithmetic work.

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If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 4 of the things that matter.

Access Rules

Grant a recipient scoped access to an item under a trigger.

Gmail → Jordan Rivera

emergency · view · reversible

Remove

1Password → Jordan Rivera

emergency · view · reversible

Remove

Chase Bank → Jordan Rivera

emergency · view · reversible

Remove

Coinbase → Jordan Rivera

emergency · view · reversible

Remove

Passport → Pat Morgan

caregiver · view · reversible

Remove

NEW RULE

Vault item

Select an item...

▼

Recipient

Select a recipient...

▼

Trigger type

emergency

▼

Scope

view

▼

☒ Reversible

Release after

0

days

Add rule

Rules: who can reach what, under which condition.

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If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 4 of the things that matter.

Triggers

What would have to happen before anything opens, and how long Relay waits before it starts asking whether you are all right.

Check-in interval (days)

30

Save

I'm fine — check in

YOUR TRIGGERS

Caregiver

ARMED

0/2 confirmations

Start this now

People who must agree first:

2

Set

Emergency

ARMED

0/1 confirmations

Start this now

People who must agree first:

1

Set

Triggers: how many verifiers must agree, per condition.

Before you start the tests, check the readiness banner. The product tells you whether your plan would actually work — whether the people you named have accepted, whether anything is set aside, whether a quorum is achievable. If it says something is missing, believe it. It is usually right and it is the fastest debugging tool in the product.

Part 2 — Standby setup

DOUG AND THE VERIFIERS · ABOUT TWO MINUTES

This is the part we are watching most closely, because it is the part a real person has to get through with no help. **Please note how long it takes you and anything that made you pause** — even for a second, even if you worked it out.

2.1 — You will be given a short code

Steve will send or read you a code. Go to the address he gives you and type the code in. There is no link to click, and that is deliberate — Relay never sends a sign-in link, so anything that looks like one is not from us.

RELAY

Enter your invitation code

Someone has named you in their Relay plan. Type the code they gave you – they may have read it out, texted it, or written it down.

Invitation code

4KMPQ-7XR2W

Continue

Nothing is being opened. Accepting only tells them you have seen it.

Not sure about any of this? [Read the common questions](#) or ask us.

N

Claiming, on a phone. This is the screen we most want your reaction to.

2.2 — What you have just done, and what you have not

You now have a free account that holds nothing of yours. It exists so that on a bad day you can simply sign in as yourself, rather than being emailed a code you have never seen before while trying to make a decision about someone you love.

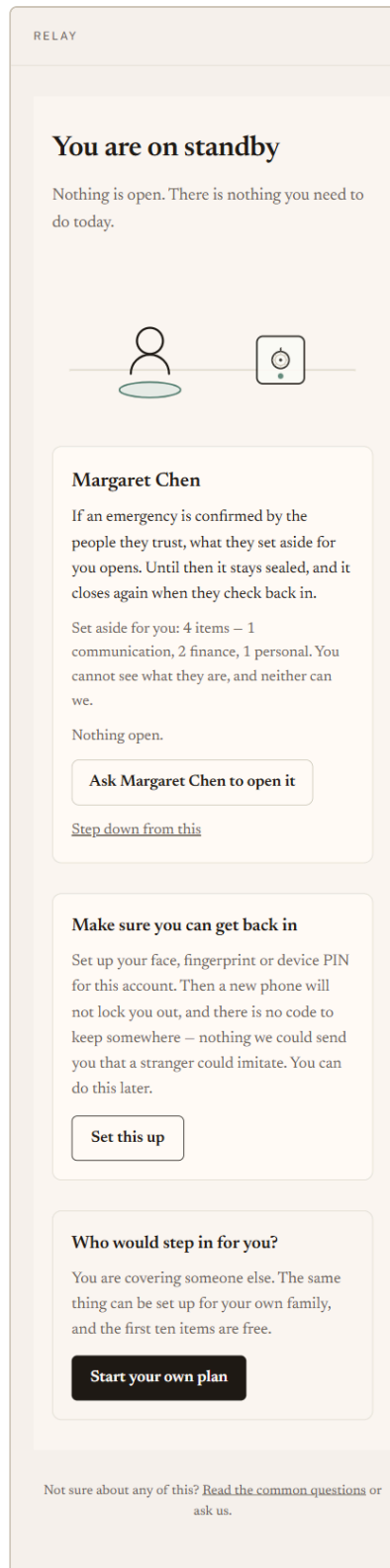
Accepting **does not** open anything, does not give you access to Steve's vault, and does not commit you to anything. There is a control for stepping down at any time, and using it is a perfectly good test result.

2.3 — Set up a passkey if you are offered one

Worth doing — it is what lets you get back in on a new phone without anyone reissuing anything. It is also a thing we would like tested on more than one kind of device.

2.4 — Expect a phone call from Steve

He will read four words. Check they match the four on your screen and tell him. It takes thirty seconds and it is the step that makes your answer count for anything later.



Standing by. Most days this screen says the most valuable thing it can say: nothing is open and there is nothing to do.

Record for Part 4: how long the claim took, whether the email (if you got one) was in your inbox or junk, what mail provider you use, and the first moment you were unsure what to do.

Part 3 — The tests

EIGHT SCENARIOS · RUN T1 FIRST, THE REST IN ANY ORDER

Each test says who runs it, what to do, and what should happen. **If what happens differs from "what should happen", that is the finding** — write down what you saw and roughly when.

T1 The whole thing, end to end

Everyone · start here · about 15 minutes

The one test that matters most, because it is the product's actual purpose.

1. **Steve** fires an emergency from the Triggers screen and confirms it.
2. **Verifier** gets asked one question and answers yes. (Check junk — \$0.2.)
3. **Doug** opens his standby screen and finds access is open.
4. **Doug** presses Reveal and reads what was set aside — then **actually tries the credential** on the real service, if it was a real one.
5. **Steve** checks in, which closes it again.
6. **Doug** refreshes and confirms it is shut.

Should happen: access opens the moment the verifier answers — no waiting period. Doug sees labelled fields (username, password, and a live six-digit code if that item had two-factor), not a blob of text. When Steve checks in, Doug's access closes and the screen says so. **The credential should actually work on the real service.**

Record: did the verifier's email arrive, and where? Was it obvious to Doug that something had opened? Did the revealed detail actually let him in?

Your access plan

Margaret Chen chose to share these with you. Relay gives you access, not legal authority.

Work top to bottom – the most consequential items come first.

DO TODAY

1 Primary email [view](#)

[Reveal](#)

Fastmail

USERNAME

[Copy](#)

margaret.chen@fastmail.test

PASSWORD

[Show](#) [Copy](#)

.....

TWO-FACTOR CODE

[Copy](#)

5 0 5 2 8 7

New code in 25s · type it straight after the password

RECOVERY CODES

[Copy](#)

8f2k-91mz

q4rt-77bd

zz10-4kkp

Each of these works once. If more than one of you has access, agree who uses which.

N

T1, step 4 — what Doug should see. Labelled fields, password masked until asked for, and a live two-factor code if the item had one.

T2 Doug asks, and Steve is fine

Doug, then Steve · 5 minutes

1. **Doug** uses "ask them to open it" on his standby screen and gives a reason.
2. **Steve** gets asked first, and answers "**I'm fine**".
3. **Doug** sees the outcome.

Should happen: nothing opens, no verifier is ever contacted, and Doug is told plainly. This is the false-alarm path and it exists so that the verifiers do not get bothered for nothing — a verification network that gets pinged constantly stops answering.

Record: was Doug's ask easy to find? Did the refusal feel clear or curt?

T3 Doug asks, and Steve says yes

Doug, then Steve · 5 minutes

Same as T2, but Steve **approves** instead.

Should happen: access opens immediately, with no verifier involved at all. The reasoning: if the owner is sitting right there agreeing, asking three other people to vote on it is absurd. Steve should then check in to close it.

T4 A verifier says no

Steve and one verifier · 5 minutes

1. **Steve** fires an emergency.
2. **The verifier** answers **no** — or abstains, if offered.

Should happen: nothing opens. The refusal is recorded and Steve can see it. A "no" should be as easy to give as a "yes" — if declining felt awkward or hidden, say so, because a verifier who feels pressured to agree is a broken safeguard.

T5 Two verifiers required

Steve and two verifiers · 10 minutes

Steve raises the emergency trigger to require **2** confirmations, then fires it. One verifier answers yes.

Should happen: nothing opens on one answer — the tally shows 1 of 2. When the second verifier answers, access opens. If it opens on the first answer, that is a serious finding and worth an immediate message.

T6 Standing down, and stepping away

Anyone · 5 minutes

A verifier or recipient uses the control to step down from Steve's circle.

Should happen: it works without a fight, Steve is told, and his readiness banner now says the plan is short a person. Saying no should be genuinely easy — that is a deliberate property, and if it felt like a dark pattern we want to know.

T7 The slow one — Steve stops checking in

Steve · needs at least a full day of doing nothing

Set the check-in interval to its minimum (one day) and then simply do not check in. Leave it alone and get on with your life.

Should happen: after the interval passes, the plan arms itself and the people you named are asked — without you doing anything. The checker runs hourly, so expect it within an hour of the interval elapsing rather than to the second. **This is the test that proves the product works when the owner cannot act**, which is the entire premise, so it is worth the wait even though it is dull.

Record: did it fire at roughly the right time? Was the warning you got beforehand (if any) enough notice?

T8 Losing your phone

Steve, and one other tester if willing · 10 minutes

Sign out, then get back in using a **recovery code** instead of the authenticator — pretend the phone is gone. Do this while you still have the codes in front of you.

Should happen: you get back in, and the code you used is spent and cannot be reused. The count of remaining codes should visibly drop.

Do not test this by actually destroying your access. If you have no recovery codes, skip T8 and say so — there is no way back and we would rather have a tester than a data point.

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If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach all 4 of the things that matter.

What happened

17 entries · append-only, hash-chained.

Server: intact

Client: —

Verify chain

On 8/12/2026 an emergency was raised and nobody confirmed it. Nothing was opened, and it is closed again.

Closed 8/12/2026, 9:51:51 PM — because you checked back in. Nothing else was reachable, and nothing stayed open.

On 8/12/2026 an emergency was raised and nobody confirmed it. Nothing was opened, and it is closed again.

Closed 8/12/2026, 9:50:36 PM — because you checked back in. Nothing else was reachable, and nothing stayed open.

On 8/12/2026 an emergency was raised and nobody confirmed it. Nothing was opened, and it is closed again.

Closed 8/12/2026, 9:44:41 PM — because you checked back in. Nothing else was reachable, and nothing stayed open.

Every entry

The full record, in the order it happened. Nothing here can be edited or removed — that is what makes the summary above trustworthy rather than merely reassuring.

SEQ	TIME	ACTOR	ACTION	ENTITY	DETAIL	HASH
0	8/12/2026, 9:41:21 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	break_glass_issued	verifier · 33f971f5	view	172f43a59b89...
1	8/12/2026, 9:41:22 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	break_glass_issued	verifier · 1b8807c7	view	9f6de42dacbc...
2	8/12/2026, 9:44:18 PM	system	release_transition_pending	release_state · e345f931	view	6155b8d88cc2...
3	8/12/2026, 9:44:19 PM	system	release_transition_grace	release_state · e345f931	view	054d700e86a4...
4	8/12/2026, 9:44:19 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	trigger_initiated	release_state · e345f931	view	6bb52816d3ed...
5	8/12/2026, 9:44:41 PM	system	release_transition_armed	release_state · e345f931	view	12743577418a...
6	8/12/2026, 9:44:41 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	owner_checkin	release_state	view	1d8403c7190f...
7	8/12/2026, 9:50:11 PM	system	release_transition_pending	release_state · ef3c990a	view	038d1805ec3e...
8	8/12/2026, 9:50:11 PM	system	release_transition_grace	release_state · ef3c990a	view	bec38a27d189...
9	8/12/2026, 9:50:11 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	trigger_initiated	release_state · ef3c990a	view	509ca50d37bb...
10	8/12/2026, 9:50:36 PM	system	release_transition_armed	release_state · ef3c990a	view	341fce6dc3ef...
11	8/12/2026, 9:50:36 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	trigger_stood_down	release_state · ef3c990a	view	00dbfe9d771e...
12	8/12/2026, 9:51:36 PM	system	release_transition_pending	release_state · ef3c990a	view	4ac7de4f3021...
13	8/12/2026, 9:51:36 PM	system	release_transition_grace	release_state · ef3c990a	view	d8a1d3ad5419...
14	8/12/2026, 9:51:36 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	trigger_initiated	release_state · ef3c990a	view	1d65f1092988...
15	8/12/2026, 9:51:51 PM	system	release_transition_armed	release_state · ef3c990a	view	31139ca29a5c...
16	8/12/2026, 9:51:51 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:3ed8718c-aa51-48f4-aebb-e876fcb7ee75	trigger_stood_down	release_state · ef3c990a	view	5c2cae37b273...

After the tests, the audit log should read as a plain account of everything that happened. If it does not match what you remember doing, that is worth reporting.

Part 4 — What to tell us

EVERYONE · FIFTEEN MINUTES AT THE END

This is the part that makes the whole exercise worth doing. Rough notes are fine — bullet points in an email are perfect. Send to hello@relaystandby.com, or use the form on relaystandby.com/help, or just tell Steve.

The five questions we most need answered

1. **Where did you first hesitate?** The exact screen or sentence where you were not sure what to do. Even if you worked it out in five seconds. *Especially* then.
2. **Did you understand what you were agreeing to** when you claimed your account? In your own words, what does being a recipient or a verifier mean?
3. **Would you have accepted this from someone who was not Steve?** If a friend sent you this out of the blue, would you have done it, ignored it, or assumed it was a scam?
4. **Did anything feel untrustworthy?** Wording, design, a request that felt like too much. This is a product asking people to hand over their family's accounts; anything that made you uneasy is a finding, not a nitpick.
5. **Would you use this for real?** Honestly. And if not, what is the specific thing that would have to be true first? A "no, because..." is more useful to us than a polite yes.

Also worth a line each, if you noticed

- Where the emails landed — inbox or junk — and which provider you use.
- Roughly how long claiming took you, from opening the message to being done.
- Anything that looked broken on your phone specifically.
- Any word or phrase that struck you as jargon.
- Anything that took more taps than it should have.

Please do not soften it. The most expensive outcome of this round would be five people being polite about something they would never actually use. Steve has been building this alone for months and is too close to it to see what is confusing — that is the entire reason you are here. A blunt "I had no idea what this screen wanted" is the most valuable sentence you can send.

Part 5 — Known limits

DELIBERATE · PLEASE DO NOT REPORT THESE AS FAULTS

WHAT YOU WILL NOTICE	WHY
Email often lands in junk , especially Outlook/Hotmail/Live	Known and measured. Mail authenticates correctly and Microsoft files it as junk anyway. Being worked. Tell us where it landed, but it is not news that it happened.
Nothing about wills, probate or inheritance	Removed from the product on purpose. Relay covers the situation where someone is unreachable and may come back. The permanent handoff after death was deliberately taken out and is not coming back in this form.
No text messages	Not built yet. Everything is email plus the codes Steve hands over himself. Text-message alerts need a carrier registration with a multi-week lead time, which has not been started.
No mobile app	By design for now. It is a web page that works on a phone.
It does not cost you anything	Payment works and is live, but the paywall is off during the beta, so everything is available to everyone.
You cannot edit one field of a vault item — changing a password means re-entering the whole item	Known and deliberate for now. It exists as a limitation because with a handful of items nobody is retyping much; if it annoys you during testing, say so , because that is exactly the evidence that would change it.
The owner has to phone each person	Not laziness — the four-word call is the only step that proves the person who accepted is the person Steve meant. Everything else reduces to trusting an email inbox, which is the thing most likely to be compromised in the exact scenario the product exists for.

If you get stuck

- **The full user guide** is at relaystandby.com/help — it covers every screen in much more detail than this document.
- **Nothing you can press will destroy Steve's data.** Releases are reversible; he checks in and they close. Explore freely — poking at things is the job.
- **If something looks properly broken**, note the time and roughly what you had just done. That is enough to find it in the logs afterwards.

Finally, the thing that is easy to forget: you are not testing whether the software runs. It runs — that has been checked to death by machines. You are testing whether it makes sense to a human being who did not build it, and whether the promise it makes is one you would actually rely on. Only you can answer that, and nobody has yet.

Thank you — genuinely. Five people spending an hour on this is worth more to Relay than any amount of further building.